

EXECUTIVE BRIEF

Walmart's baseline and goals, as drafted, describe a pilot that cannot pass.

Walmart's own search data shows organic traffic falling 11% year over year and accelerating. Their proposed baseline contains none of that decline and adds a holiday curve their traffic has never shown. Their goals then sit above the most optimistic outcome our model produces at any launch date.

THEIR ORGANIC SEARCH TREND	BASELINE INFLATION · SEP-DEC	THRESHOLD VS OUR BEST CASE
-19.8% July 2026 Google clicks vs July 2025 — the worst month in a nine-month run where every month is down. Full period: -10.8%.	+~100M Annex A totals 693M visits. Their own run-rate, shape and trend give 591M. Even with zero decline: 655M.	1.4–2.2× Walmart wants 45.3M incremental visits. Our <i>high</i> case delivers 31M at a Sep 1 launch, 20M at Sep 24. The contract's low tier: 2–3M.

Combined effect. Measured against Annex A, actual traffic lands 80–100M visits below baseline before SpeedWorkers adds its first visit. The effective bar becomes roughly 130M incremental visits — four times our most optimistic model at the best launch date, six times at the realistic one.

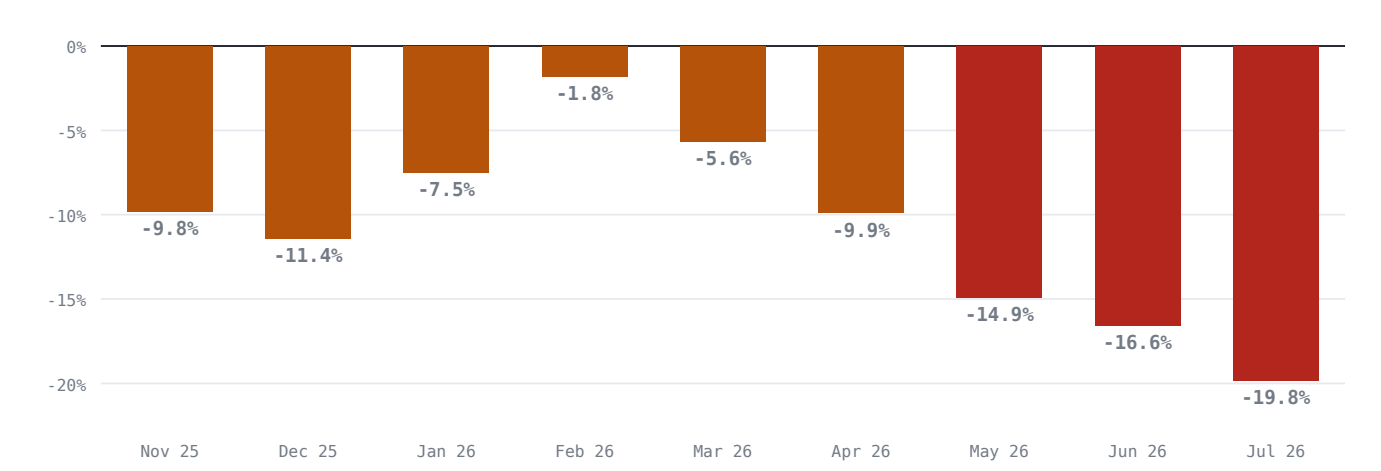
Every check in this brief uses Walmart's numbers: their visit counts for scale, their Search Console history for shape and trend, their scorecards for AI. Nothing here depends on Botify's forecast being right.

The six angles

1 · Their traffic is declining and it is accelerating · 2 · The baseline ignores the decline · 3 · The baseline's shape is not organic search · 4 · What that does to the pilot's arithmetic · 5 · The goals against our model at real launch dates · 6 · What 45.3M means as growth · then what we recommend.

Walmart's organic search traffic is falling, and the fall is speeding up.

This is Walmart's own Google Search Console data for walmart.com (US, web), compared month by month against the same month a year earlier. Every month since November is down. The last three average -17%.



Google clicks, year over year, by month. Nine consecutive months of decline. Impressions are up 20% over the same span, so this is not lost demand — Walmart is being shown more and clicked less.

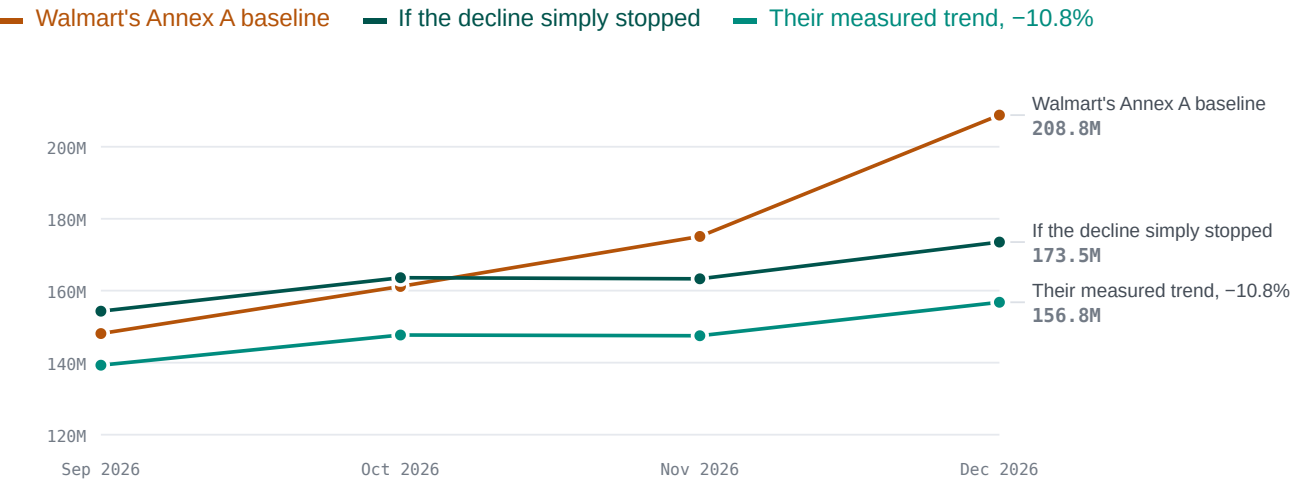
WINDOW	GOOGLE CLICKS	YEAR BEFORE	CHANGE
Nov 2025 – Jul 2026	508.5M	572.0M	-11.1%
May – Jul 2026	160.0M	193.1M	-17.1%
Jul 2026 alone	53.1M	66.3M	-19.8%
299 comparable days	559.9M	627.9M	-10.8%

Why it matters for the pilot. Any honest "year-over-year run-rate" baseline for Sep–Dec 2026 must be lower than Sep–Dec 2025. Bing is down too (-4.2%). Nothing in this account is flat, and nothing suggests the trend reverses on its own before December.

Source: Google Search Console, walmart.com US/Web, day grain, 2024-10-15 → 2026-08-09, from Frank's measurement-framework archive. Bing Webmaster Tools, 514 days to 2026-08-08.

Annex A contains no decline at all — and then some.

Annex A says it applies "a year-over-year run-rate methodology to Walmart's current performance." We rebuilt that projection from Walmart's own inputs. Their number is above it in every month, and the gap widens as the holidays approach.



September is fine; December is not. Annex A's September is within 4% of a no-decline projection. By December it is 20% above even that line and 33% above the measured trend.

2026	ANNEX A	NO DECLINE	MEASURED TREND	ANNEX A VS TREND
September	148.1M	154.3M	139.3M	+6%
October	161.2M	163.6M	147.7M	+9%
November	175.1M	163.3M	147.5M	+19%
December	208.8M	173.5M	156.8M	+33%
Sep – Dec	693.2M	654.7M	591.3M	+17% · ~102M

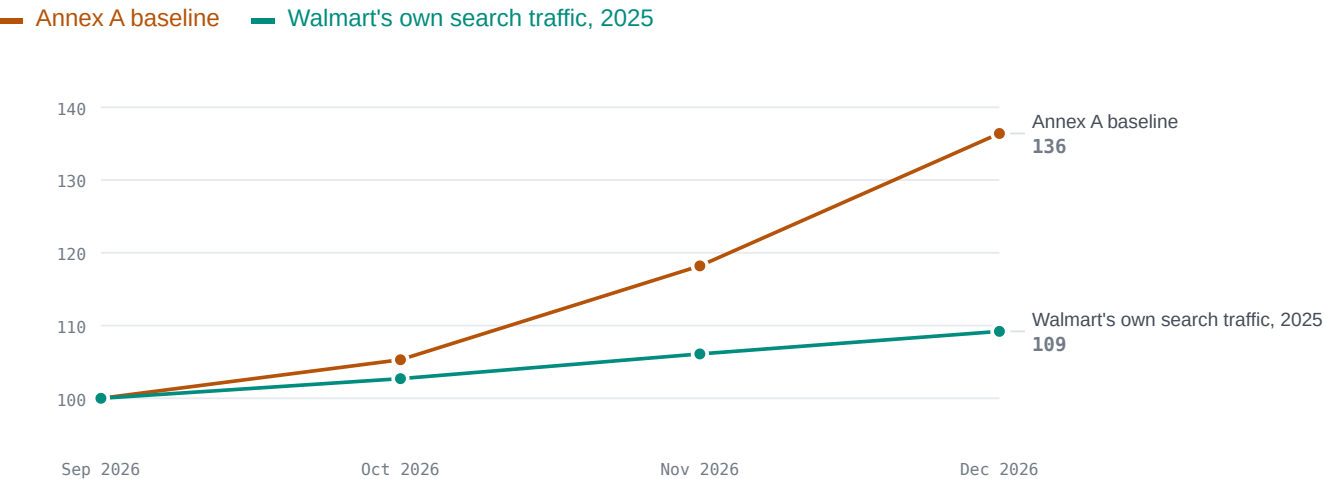
Are they ignoring the decline? Yes — and the September number shows how.

Their September matches Walmart's *current* run-rate carried forward with no decline. From there the curve rises 41% into December. The growth embedded in the search portion of Annex A is **+6% year over year**, in a channel their own data puts at -11% to -20%. For Annex A to be true, Walmart would need 2.66 visits per search click; their own scorecards say 2.18–2.25.

Method: Sep–Dec 2025 Google + Bing clicks by month × 2.252 visits per click (Walmart's own SEO visits ÷ our clicks, scorecard week ending 23 May 2026; the higher of two weeks), plus AI-assistant visits held flat at 1.45M/week. Bing held flat rather than at its measured -4.2%. Each choice favours Annex A.

Their holiday curve is three times steeper than their search traffic has ever been.

This test needs no conversion between visits and clicks. Index every month to September and compare the shape of Annex A with the shape of Walmart's own organic search traffic in the same months last year.



Per-day index, September = 100. Annex A climbs to 136 by December; Walmart's organic search climbed to 109. The 2024 season looked like 2025, so this is not a one-year quirk.

RATIO	ANNEX A	WALMART SEARCH, 2025	WALMART SEARCH, 2024
December ÷ November	1.19	1.06	1.07
December ÷ September	1.41	1.13	n/a (archive starts Oct 2024)
November ÷ September	1.18	1.06	n/a

Where does a 41% Sep-to-Dec climb come from?

Not from organic search. Walmart's holiday surge in search is real but modest, and it is mostly *branded* queries — which SpeedWorkers does not act on. A 41% climb is what total-site or all-channel traffic (paid, app, direct, email) does in Q4. If Annex A was built from that, it measures a channel the pilot does not touch, and the December number is not a baseline for this pilot at all.

Measured against Annex A, we start 80–100M visits in the hole.

Incremental visits are defined as actual minus baseline. If Walmart's traffic simply follows its own trend — no SpeedWorkers effect at all — here is what the contract would record each month.

2026	WHERE THEIR TRAFFIC LANDS ON TREND	ANNEX A BASELINE	"INCREMENTAL" RECORDED, WITH ZERO SPEEDWORKERS EFFECT
September	139.4M	148.1M	-8.7M
October	147.5M	161.2M	-13.7M
November	147.6M	175.1M	-27.5M
December (full month)	156.6M	208.8M	-52.2M
Sep 1 – Dec 20 (measurement window)	535.6M	619.1M	-83.5M

DEFICIT BEFORE WE START

-84M

Visits the contract would record as "lost" over the measurement window if SpeedWorkers did nothing and Walmart's traffic simply followed its trend. Counting all of September: -102M.

WALMART'S STATED THRESHOLD

45.3M

Cumulative incremental visits by Dec 20. The baseline deficit alone is 1.8–2.3× this number.

EFFECTIVE THRESHOLD

~129M

What SpeedWorkers would actually have to generate for the contract to record 45.3M. Our high case: 31M (Sep 1) · 20M (Sep 24).

The baseline error is larger than the entire goal. Whether the pilot "passes" is decided almost entirely by the baseline, not by SpeedWorkers. A pilot that works perfectly — deployment healthy, render timeouts gone, indexation moving — still reads as a large negative number against Annex A. That is the failure mode Frank's framework was built to prevent, and it is exactly what this Annex reintroduces.

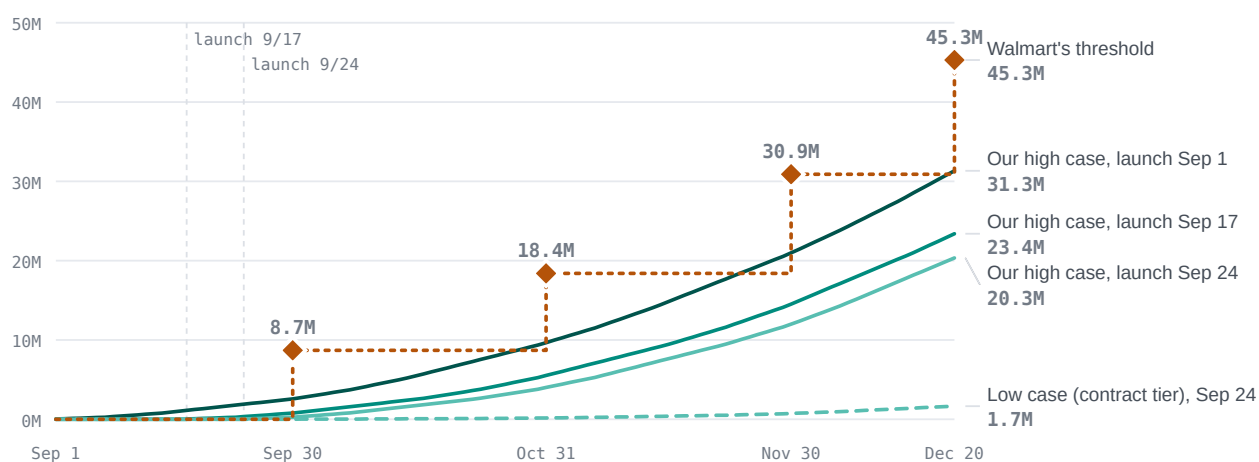
"On trend" = Sep–Dec 2025 actuals × (1 – 10.8%) for Google, Bing flat, at 2.252 visits per click, plus flat AI visits. Using the recent -17.1% trend the deficit is ~120M.

No tier of our forecast reaches any of Walmart's checkpoints at any launch date.

Frank's model reproduces the addendum's figures exactly. We re-ran it at a Sep 1, Sep 17 and Sep 24 launch, converted its clicks to visits at Walmart's own ratio, and added its AI-visit series — Walmart's unit and Walmart's channel definition.

■ Walmart's \$16.4 goals ■ Our high case, launch Sep 1 ■ High case, Sep 17 ■ High case, Sep 24

■ Low case (contract tier), Sep 24



CUMULATIVE INCREMENTAL VISITS	SEP 30	OCT 31	NOV 30	DEC 20	GOAL ÷ OURS
Walmart's goal	8.7M	18.4M	30.9M	45.3M	—
Our high case · launch Sep 1	2.6M	9.7M	21.0M	31.3M	1.4×
Our high case · launch Sep 24	0.3M	4.0M	12.0M	20.3M	2.2×
Our mid case · launch Sep 24	0.1M	1.5M	4.8M	8.5M	5.3×
Contract low tier · launch Sep 24	0.01M	0.2M	0.7M	1.7M	27×

The September checkpoint is impossible on any date. 8.7M by Sep 30 means more incremental visits in the first 6–13 days of serving than our high case earns by Halloween. Month one of any deployment runs at 2–20% of full pace while search engines recrawl.

The launch slip also loses the Full Scale gate.

80% of pages must be served by Sep 30. At 250 URLs/s that is 40% on a Sep 17 launch and 18% on Sep 24. Adjustment Days relieve thresholds; nothing in the SOW restores a missed gate. Even relieved for the slip, 45.3M becomes 22.8M — still above our high case.

They are asking for a year of best-case growth in twelve weeks, against a falling tide.

Three ways to size the ask, all on Walmart's own numbers.

AS A LIFT ON THEIR WHOLE ORGANIC BASE	AGAINST OUR ANNUAL HIGH CASE	AGAINST THEIR DECLINE
+10.6% 45.3M incremental visits on the ~429M organic + AI visits Walmart's trend gives for Sep 24 – Dec 20. In one quarter, during ramp-up, on a channel where SpeedWorkers touches only the non-branded 6%.	≈ 1 year At full coverage for a full year, our model lifts the base +4.0% (low), +7.5% (mid), +11.1% (high). Walmart's quarter-long ask equals the high case's entire annual output.	71% Walmart's Sep–Dec organic decline at –10.8% is ~63M visits. The goal asks the pilot to reverse 71% of a year's decline in one quarter. Our high case reverses 49% at a Sep 1 launch; the low tier, 5%.

Put another way

	WALMART'S OWN TREND	ANNEX A IMPLIES	45.3M GOAL IMPLIES
Organic visits, Sep–Dec 2026 vs 2025	–11% (search) · recent –17%	+6% (search portion)	—
Required swing vs trend	—	≈ 17 points	≈ 8–11 points more, on top
What our model says the pilot moves the trend by	Low ≈ 0.6 points · High ≈ 5 points, exiting the window at 40–90% adoption		

The honest framing. The pilot can succeed as a proof of mechanism — and Walmart's organic traffic can still be down year over year in December. Frank's framework was designed so that this is measured fairly against the trend without Botify. Annex A and \$16.4 replace that with a baseline that assumes growth and a goal that assumes a year's work in a quarter.

Base in the window: Sep–Dec 2025 actuals on trend, pro-rated to Sep 24 – Dec 20. Model annual lifts from forecast.py annual_targets() on a 757.6M-click combined base. Decline in visits = 28.1M Google clicks × 2.252.

Do not sign Annex A or §16.4 as drafted. Ask four questions and propose the baseline we already built.

- ① **Ask for the Annex A worksheet.**
Which base months, which year-over-year rate, and for which channel. Their own Search Console says -10.8%; the Annex implies +6%. If the curve came from all-channel traffic, it is the wrong channel for an organic pilot.
- ② **Ask where the September-to-December curve comes from.**
Their organic search does 1.13 Sep → Dec; the Annex does 1.41. This single question accounts for most of the 100M.
- ③ **Propose the countersigned baseline Frank already built.**
Walmart's own organic + AI visits for 1 Sep – 20 Dec 2025 from their system of record, grown by the measured trend, frozen before go-live. Better still, the URL-hash holdout Frank is confirming with engineering: with a control group the projected baseline stops mattering.
- ④ **Re-anchor the goals to the go-live date and to our model's tiers.**
Checkpoints launch-relative, the Target Full Scale Date moving with go-live, and the threshold set at the low tier the addendum already names — or Walmart states which tier of our forecast they believe they are signing. The 45.3M sits close to the original deck's high case, a figure we have since restated 30–40% lower.

What would change this reading

- Walmart analytics showing organic + AI visits Sep–Dec 2025 materially above 2.25× our click archive.
- A Walmart-side organic seasonal history with a Dec/Sep ratio near 1.4. Nothing in Search Console or Bing looks like that in either year we hold.
- Evidence the 2026 decline has reversed since 9 August. July was the worst reading in the series.

Caveats we carry openly

- Visits-per-click rests on two scorecard weeks in May; we used the higher, which favours Walmart.
- AI visits are held flat at 1.45M/week; the last reading was falling 19% week on week.
- Our model's own open items (indexation dial, anonymized attribution, unverified AOV/CR) bear on revenue, not on the visit figures here. The high case is the model's ceiling, not a claim.

Sources: Google Search Console (walmart.com US/Web, 664 days to 9 Aug 2026); Bing Webmaster Tools (514 days to 8 Aug 2026); Walmart Agentic Commerce Scorecards W16–W17 FY27; Frank Vitovitch, Walmart Pilot Measurement Framework (forecast.py, STATE.md, correction memo, 13 Aug 2026); Annex A and §16.4 as received from Walmart, September 2026. Reproducible from the Botify repo: [analysis/baseline_check.py](#) and [analysis/model/goals_check.py](#).